
CHURN IS DEAD

The Silence Ledger Audit

Score your segments on the gap between coverage and contact

Your dashboard says every account is 'covered.' This audit tells you which segments are actually blacked out — touched by automation but silent to a human right up to the renewal or the churn. Score each segment separately; blended numbers hide the fire.

Scoring: Rate each item 1-5. 1 = not happening, 5 = embedded in operations. Run it once per customer segment, not blended.

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SECTION 1

1. Reach vs. Contact

Coverage measures whether a system touched an account; contact measures whether a human had a conversation that could change the outcome. Only the second column predicts renewal in the long tail.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Two-column reporting exists	Every segment report shows 'accounts an automation touched' and 'accounts a human spoke with' as separate numbers	A single 'coverage %' is reported to the board with no human-contact column at all
Definition of 'contact' is strict	Contact = a live call or two-way exchange lasting more than one message where a person could ask 'what's changed?'	An opened email or a chatbot how-to session is counted as 'contact'
Human-contact rate is tracked per segment	You know exactly what % of each segment had a real human conversation this quarter	Human contact is assumed from activity counts; nobody has ever pulled column two
Long-tail column two is non-zero by design	Even the lowest-ARR tier gets deliberate human moments, not just automation	Column two for the long tail is near zero and everyone reads column one as 'cared for'

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
No distinction between reach and contact; coverage % is the only metric	1
Some awareness of the difference but no separate reporting	2
Two columns exist but 'contact' is loosely defined	3
Strict human-contact rate tracked per segment	4
Two-column ledger drives staffing and board reporting; column two owns renewal forecasting	5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

2. The Save-Signal Blackout

The days between a segment's last human conversation and its renewal date is your undetected-churn window. Everything inside it — a departed champion, a new budget owner, a competitor's lunch — is invisible as a save opportunity.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Blackout is measured per segment	Average days from last human conversation to renewal is calculated for every segment	The blackout window has never been measured; nobody knows the number
Blackout is short in fragile tiers	Even long-tail accounts have a human conversation within a defined window before renewal	The blackout equals the entire contract term — last human moment was the sales call
Blackout sits next to coverage	Reports show '100% coverage, average blackout: X days' side by side	Coverage is celebrated with no blackout number in view
Blackout cannot be gamed by activity	The metric only shrinks when a real human conversation happens	Teams claim the blackout is 'covered' because automation fired more emails

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Blackout window is unknown and unmeasured	1
Measured occasionally for one or two accounts	2
Measured per segment but not acted on	3
Measured per segment with target thresholds	4
Blackout is a board-level metric and actively closed via triggered human contact	5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

3. The Trigger, Not the Cadence

Automation should summon a human at a real inflection point, not replace one on a timer. A fixed cadence that runs regardless of account reality is the design flaw that produces silence.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Usage cliffs page a human	A real usage cliff (not a plateau) alerts a named person to reach out	Usage dips only fire a re-engagement email; no human is summoned
Failed payments page a human	A failed or at-risk payment triggers immediate human outreach	Involuntary churn is handled entirely by dunning automation
Champion change is detected	New admin appearing while the old admin goes dark pages a human within days	Champion departure is not a field in telemetry; nobody notices
Automation summons, never substitutes	Every automated flow has a defined human handoff at inflection points	Cadence runs on a fixed timer regardless of what's happening in the account

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Pure cadence; automation replaces humans entirely	1
Cadence with rare manual escalation	2
Some triggers exist but most touches are scheduled	3
Real inflection triggers page humans for key events	4
Automation exists solely to summon humans at real inflections; no timer-based substitution	5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

4. Cost-to-Silence

Price what one saved long-tail account is worth against the CSM hours you cut. This answers the question a CFO will eventually ask: did automating that tier save money, or just move the loss off the dashboard?

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Saved-account value is quantified	You know the revenue value of one saved long-tail account	The value of a save is unknown, so cuts are justified on cost alone
CSM hours cut are priced against churn	The cost saved by cutting humans is netted against revenue lost to silence	Headcount savings are celebrated without measuring resulting churn
Segment NRR is viewed unblended	Long-tail NRR is reported on its own, not buried in a blended average	A healthy blended NRR hides a sub-breakeven long-tail segment
Involuntary churn share is tracked	Failed-payment and involuntary churn is measured as a % of segment losses	Involuntary churn is lumped into 'expected churn — low-touch tier'

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
No costing of silence; coverage assumed to pay for itself	1
Vague sense the tradeoff exists but no numbers	2
Some costs and losses tracked but not reconciled	3
Saved-account value netted against CSM hours cut per segment	4
Full cost-to-silence model drives coverage decisions; segment NRR and involuntary churn reported unblended	5

Your Score: ____ / 5

CHURN IS DEAD

Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. 1. Reach vs. Contact	_____	5
2. 2. The Save-Signal Blackout	_____	5
3. 3. The Trigger, Not the Cadence	_____	5
4. 4. Cost-to-Silence	_____	5
TOTAL	_____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Uncuttable	Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable.
12-15	Defensible	Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension.
8-11	Vulnerable	Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent.
4-7	Critical	Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed.

What to do next: Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

You did not scale your reach. You scaled the absence of a relationship.

-- Kuber

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